

Speaker 1: Ready. I think it started now. Okay, let's go. How old are you?

Speaker 2: [31-35].

Speaker 1: How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2: [11-15] years.

Speaker 1: Do you have children?

Speaker 2: We have [1-5], [6-10] years old.

Speaker 1: Who do you live with?

Speaker 2: Just me, my husband, and my [Child].

Speaker 1: What is your main source of income and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2: My main source of income is just me, right? I'm a [Job Title].

Speaker 1: Great. So, moving on to the questions, first, it's important to ask. Do you have any preference on how I should refer to your husband, as a partner, or just [Partner]?

Speaker 2: [Partner].

Speaker 1: Okay, so starting here. Can you tell me more or less about your love story? Remember, for all the questions, the more you can tell me, the better. I need a lot of information.

Speaker 2: Alright. We met in a very casual way. My sister was dating a childhood friend of his, who introduced us. We met at a [location]. The same day we met, we hooked up. And from there, we kept in touch, seeing each other. Initially, he was the only one who wanted to date. Shortly after we met, I even went on a trip with my family and he traveled alone, well, with friends. After this trip, he came back with lots of gifts for me. At that time, we were just hooking up. He brought presents for my whole family. He had gone to the [Country A] and I went to [Country B]. It was his first international trip. I hadn't traveled much outside [Country C] either. I went to [Country B] and such. At that time, the internet didn't work well there. Especially for me. We kept in touch while traveling.

But when we got back, he brought me lots of things. He brought gifts for my sister, my parents, for me. I was really surprised. At first, I told him I didn't want to date, that I wasn't looking for anything serious. But then, the tables turned. He accepted not dating. Then I said, no, I want to date, I do want to. And I ended up asking him to date.

Speaker 1: Wow! That's great! So, the next question here is how would you compare the quality of your relationship to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: Wow, that's hard. I think we never really know other people's relationships. We see who they are around us. But to see how they really are, that's very difficult. I think we don't really know almost anyone.

Speaker 1: You can answer based on what you see, what you have access to.

Speaker 2: No, because I have access to my family's relationships. I think mine is the most balanced. Of all.

Speaker 1: Would you mind telling me how many romantic partners you've had?

Speaker 2: Wow, that's hard because... Like, casual flings, hookups, right? I don't know... Okay, I think more than [16-20]. Or more. As for serious relationships, he was my [1st-5th] boyfriend.

Speaker 1: And how do you compare the quality of your current relationship to the previous ones, and why?

Speaker 2: The previous ones, I think they weren't good because there was a huge difference in mindset. I dated very immature guys, in my opinion. Guys who didn't have many future plans. They couldn't talk about the same things I did. I was very young too, right? I know, I was in a different phase of life because I was studying hard and preparing for medical school and the guys were on a different track.

Speaker 1: You were [21-25], right? From what I understand.

Speaker 1: [21-25] years old. That's very young.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 2: And for you, I remember you mentioned the word, right? You defined your relationship as the most balanced among those you see in your family. What do you think makes a relationship high quality or low quality?

Speaker 1: First of all, respect. So, conversations need to be had. There shouldn't be yelling in a relationship. This is something I lived within my family, my father until today, right? Despite having a long relationship of, I don't know, more than [40-45] years of marriage. But until today, when there's any disagreement, when there's anything, he yells. I think this greatly reduces the quality of a relationship. That, in itself, is disrespectful. So, respect first. Another important thing that I think makes it work in my case is giving in. We both give in a lot, both me and [Partner]. So, I give in to please him, to make him happy, and he gives in to please me, to make

me happy. If it weren't like that, it wouldn't work. If we defended our points to the last moment, we wouldn't have lasted even a year.

Speaker 1: So, would you say a high-quality relationship wouldn't have this part, for example, of yelling, which you don't find good, and also the part of giving in to each other?

Speaker 2: Yes, yes. Always showing the importance of the other in your life, too. That's something important to me. Always showing the importance of the other and he showing my importance to him, right? Because sometimes that gets lost in a long relationship. You start getting into a routine, especially after having children, and then you start to feel unnoticed, like you're just sharing the same house, but you forget the romantic, loving part.

Speaker 1: The couple aspect, right? I understand. And for you, what's most important in a relationship?

Speaker 2: For me, it's admiration for the other. The respect I already mentioned. And having quality time together, happy moments with each other. With kids, that's complicated, but it has to happen, otherwise, the relationship falls apart. I think it's basically what I said before. Demonstration. You keep reinforcing the importance of the other to you.

Speaker 1: And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2: I'm eating a pear, is it making noise?

Speaker 1: No, no. Keep eating.

Speaker 2: What is love? Love? Love. I think it's a very advanced stage of the relationship because I don't even know if I could consider that there was love at the beginning. Even in the first years, I think it's difficult. It's a stage that comes after passion. It's that phase where you know the person so well that you already know practically all the flaws and all the qualities and live well with that. You even start to enjoy the person's own flaws, to overlook them, and it stops being important. You can't see yourself without the person anymore. You're talking about romantic love, right? Because there are other kinds of love.

Speaker 1: Yes, yes. Regarding the relationship.

Speaker 2: You see that person as such a good partner, almost an extension of yourself. You see the couple as one. That's it.

Speaker 1: Some questions may seem a bit repetitive, but the more you can vary the answers for me, the better. For example, how important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2: Oh my God, let me think for a moment. How important is love in a relationship? It's the main thing. There's no way to have a relationship without love because without love, you're

just with a companion, a friend, a partner. But love involves admiration, this well-being in being with the person, and the projection of the future. Love also has this, being able to see a future with the person, wanting to be with the person in the future. If you don't have this, there's no way.

Speaker 1: And how do you know that [Partner] loves you?

Speaker 2: So, [Partner]'s way of showing love is completely different from mine. I'm the kind of person who is always saying, I love you, I love you. You're the best husband I could have. I know he loves me because he shows it by doing things for me. That's how he shows it to his family too. He's always worried about me. He's always taking the load off my day-to-day, for example, with [Child], our son. When he sees I'm very tired, he takes care of [Child] so I can rest. If I'm sick, he worries about me, he takes care of me. So I'd say I know [Partner] loves me by the way he takes care of me. More than by talking, that's his way. He's not the type to make surprises in the day-to-day or say things to me. So it's like this, he's totally dedicated in the sense of doing everything to make me happy, to make me well. That's it.

Speaker 1: And do you and [Partner] have disagreements, difficulties in the relationship too?

Speaker 2: Of course we do. Who doesn't?

Speaker 1: And how often do they happen, would you say?

Speaker 2: Well, as I mentioned, the part of giving in is very important in our relationship. So, diverging to the point of having an argument or a fight, I think I can count on one hand the times we've had this in [11-15] years. It's rare. But we do have general disagreements without arguing or fighting. We differ even in our personalities because we are very different. I am more outgoing, I like to go out, I'm more extroverted, I'm more active. He's more introverted, quiet, laid-back. So, we're very different in our ways. But causing real conflict, causing problems in our relationship, that's been rare. I've had issues wanting him to change some things, especially about going out more, living more, because he would stay at home all the time. But I can't say that caused serious, grave problems. I see.

Speaker 1: So, the difference between one wanting to go out and the other not isn't necessarily a cause, but could you tell me what these difficulties are about when they happen? Does it include fights or anything?

Speaker 2: You mean the point where we differ?

Speaker 1: Yes, within the difficulties or divergences. What are they usually about when they happen? Can you say?

Speaker 2: It's because I feel unhappy when I don't have my social needs fulfilled. For him, the pandemic was wonderful. He stayed locked inside the house, watching TV, playing his video

games. So, I think this has always been a point. And another important thing that has always caused divergence between us is raising our son. When you have a child and come from different upbringings, this also causes a lot of conflict. He had a completely different upbringing from mine in many aspects. For example, we differ in our son's diet. I come from a family with a healthier diet, a concern with this. He comes from a family where food, including, is part of their affectionate demonstration. His mother is a great cook, always made a lot of tasty but not necessarily healthy food. He didn't have a healthy childhood diet and we differ a lot on this. This really causes arguments. But our arguments are more like conversations, respectful conversations. We don't get upset with each other, stop talking, or disrespect each other. But we have a lot of disagreements on our son's education, especially his diet. And about screen time because [Partner], being more introverted and into screens, likes video games, movies, and so on. I prefer going out, being outdoors, meeting people, visiting people. These are causes of conflict between us. I don't remember what the question was.

Speaker 1: No, no, I understand. It was about the causes of these divergences in general.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: And you mentioned the importance of showing importance in the day-to-day, going out together, etc. Do you have other ways or strategies to maintain the relationship as well?

Speaker 2: This has always been complicated for us because we had [Child] right after we got married. Before [Child], our life was very busy because we lived with our parents, I was in college, then residency. So, the time we had together was weekends. We tried to have quality time and do fun things together. We got married and I got pregnant on our honeymoon. So, right after the wedding, we had a child. With a child, it's complicated to have time with your partner. You have to work hard and plan to have quality time together. We tried to institute some things, like a couple's day during the week. But it involves logistics, like who will stay with [Child] for us to go out together. But we try. We like to go out to dinner, for example. Eating is something we both enjoy. He doesn't like going to bars much, but we both like to eat out. So, we find someone to stay with [Child] and go to a nice restaurant together. The couple's day was always on Fridays. But it often doesn't work out because we can't find someone to stay with [Child].

Speaker 1: I understand. Would you say your relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2: I think so, for sure. Because now I'll talk about [Partner]. [Partner] has a very good mindset, emotional balance that I don't see in other people. He's my safe harbor. I don't have his balance. Quite the opposite. I'm quite crazy, the chaotic type, with moments of total loss of control, anxiety, crises. He's always there, steady and strong. He's my safe harbor. He has a very good conversation. He knows how to support me. All my demands, whenever I need him, he knows how to calm me down and support me. What else? He's a great father. Since becoming a father, my admiration for him has grown exponentially. I discovered other qualities in him. He's a deconstructed man compared to men of previous generations. He shares all the

responsibilities with me, with our son and with everything at home. We have a good division of tasks in our day-to-day life. As I said, he's my support, my anchor. He's a great friend.

Speaker 1: Can you give me a concrete example, like in the day-to-day, of when he supports you, becomes your anchor?

Speaker 2: Look, mainly regarding work and [Child]. Work demands a lot from me, brings me problems with anxiety, emotional issues. Working in the [Job] is no joke, you can imagine. He's always ready to support me. Even with relationship problems at work, he's there. He always has something good to say. With [Child], he always seems to be the rational part. I carry a lot of guilt regarding motherhood and he always comes rationally and puts me back in my place. And it makes me feel much better. So you want concrete examples, right?

Speaker 1: Yeah, and you mentioned a topic, for example, about work, about the day-to-day, so it makes sense.

Speaker 2: Okay. I understand. So, with [Child], I don't know, I always think I'm being a bad mother, that I'm lacking in some things, and I say no, we're being the best we can be. He also helps me set goals. Since this is what's bothering you, for example, [Child]'s diet, even though he doesn't agree that it should be different, but if we discuss it, he says, no, let's do the following, from Monday to Friday we'll do it like this, we'll have our employee prepare the vegetables, we'll make the rice, blah blah blah, so in that respect, he's always there supporting me.

Speaker 1: What you said about the rational side, I think it tends to be much more in men generally in a relationship compared to women. I find that funny even.

Speaker 2: Right? Yes.

Speaker 1: I think men tend to be more rational and women more emotional, it's not a rule, obviously.

Speaker 2: But, in fact, at least in [Partner]'s case, I think he learned to balance more by internalizing, because expressing, I feel what's bothering me and he doesn't, he swallows it down, bottles it up and that's it. Holds a grudge. Yeah, next thing you know he's got gastritis sitting in a chair. Poor guy.

Speaker 1: And the next question is, do you believe that your relationship has changed you in any way and if so, how?

Speaker 2: Oh my, let me see. I think it has changed me a lot. As I said, you learn to give in, and you have to give in, right? So over time, you can't be the same person. So I also learned to enjoy being at home more. What else? My God, what have I changed? I think it's hard to look at ourselves, right? I'd have to stop to think, to answer this question. My God, I'd have to stop to

think. Let me see. What have I changed? I think I learned to be more tolerant, also to be with him, right? Because he is very tolerant, he is much more flexible than I am, so I ended up also becoming more tolerant, more flexible, because I used to be that person who would insist on my point of view until I got what I wanted and all, but he is so, so, so flexible that I learned to be more and I think because of that it worked out.

Speaker 1: And do you think [Partner] has changed too?

Speaker 2: I think so. I think he has changed even more than I have because he also started to make an effort to socialize to make me happy, because that's his profile, right? Like I said about love, he shows it by doing things, so he starts going out more for my sake to make me happy. Now recently, he's always been, he's an [Job], a [Job], he has jobs in his field and all, but I always talked to him about taking [exams] to have more stability, because he always worked in private companies and I think with that you don't have much stability, so because of that he has changed jobs more than three times in this period. And now he decided to take a [exam] too. I think our minds change, we change over time.

Speaker 1: Uh huh. Would you say this change happened from the beginning of the relationship?

Speaker 2: I think for these two questions, I'd have to stop and think. I have to remember who he used to be.

Speaker 1: Yeah. It's time-consuming.

Speaker 2: It's time-consuming. It's kind of a difficult question to answer without stopping to think.

Speaker 1: And do you feel secure in the relationship? If so, what makes you feel secure?

Speaker 2: This is a good one. I feel very secure because we already have something good built together. And I know him well enough to know the truth the intensity of his feelings and the truth behind the feeling.

Speaker 1: Uh huh.

Speaker 2: We already know each other to a point that we consider almost unshakable because of what we feel for each other. This might not be real, but it's the feeling we have now. We've been together for so long, we know each other so well that it's hard for something to really ruin what we have. And besides that, right, besides speaking not only of feelings, but we already have other things built together that make me more secure as well, which is we already have a house, we have a child together, and we have future plans as well. I think this is important because when you're not with someone you don't see a future with, there's no way to have stability in the relationship. This security regarding the future, and I have total security

because we've already gone through tough times, we've already faced financial difficulties, and now I know that no matter what, if he lost his job, whatever might happen, we we'll know how to get back up together. I know what to expect from him. I have no doubts regarding his character, the actions he would take in any situation. So since these are predictable things, and I already have a picture of the future with him, this makes me very secure.

Speaker 1: But in the past, do you think that at some point you didn't have this image of security in the future, you didn't have this perspective?

Speaker 2: I think especially at the beginning of the relationship, the first years when you're getting to know the person, and I say years because some people think a year of relationship is already a long relationship where you already know the person, and I say no, I think even up to the beginning of our marriage, when we got married we had [1-5] years of relationship. [1-5]? In [Year], yes. We had [1-5] years of relationship. Up to that point, I couldn't say I had security because it's a constant knowledge you gain about the person. So I didn't know what [Partner] would be like after marriage, what the division of tasks at home would be like, what he would be like as a father, all of that. And right at the beginning, dating, I think it's part of dating too, you're getting to know the person, that person is a complete stranger to you. So you don't know if everything they're showing and doing is real, because we see many people getting disappointed, [1-5] years into a relationship realizing the person was nothing like they had imagined. I think at the beginning, the person is what you create in your head. The person is the image you created, so some people put their partner on a pedestal right at the beginning, right, and there's the perfect person, the person and I think all of this only fades away with a long time in the relationship. Then there's no more pedestal, but there's also no more deep hole where you put the person, which would be the opposite extreme of the pedestal. So you start to see the person as they really are, the whole package, the complete set of flaws and qualities, and then yes, you know who they are and can have security regarding that.

Speaker 1: Yes. This part here now that we have, I'm going to share the screen and show you two images of two scales with two questions, and then you'll answer based on the scales. I'll share it so you can understand. Let me share here. Can you see it already?

Speaker 2: Yes, more or less. Not really. More or less. Okay, it's fine. I can see it. I can read it. Because the screen is small, I thought I'd have trouble, but I can read it.

Speaker 1: Can you see it better now? Yes, I can see it well. So, here we have, right, the first phrase "my partner really listens to me". This scale here being, right, from 1 not true at all to 9 completely true, I'd like you to indicate the number that most represents how true this statement is for you.

Speaker 2: Okay, this one is 9.

Speaker 1: 9. Good, the same thing here. Another phrase, "my partner cares about my needs". From 1 not true at all to 9 completely true, can you indicate the number you'd choose?

Speaker 2: I think 8.

Speaker 1: 8. Okay. So, in relation to the first phrase, can you explain why you gave the number 9?

Speaker 2: Right here, my partner really listens to me. Yes. I gave 9 because [Partner] is the best listener I've ever met in my life. So, at any time, any moment, he stops everything he's doing to listen to me, to calm me down, to support me. He has that gift.

Speaker 1: And in relation to the second phrase, right, my partner cares about my needs, why did you give an 8?

Speaker 2: I think he understands, he cares about my needs that he understands, but those he doesn't understand, he ends up not caring just because he doesn't understand them, it's not for any other reason. No. I need to, let me think here, right now I need time for myself to do nothing. I need time alone with friends and all, and he just doesn't understand that, so he ends up respecting it, but not caring to give me those moments.

Speaker 1: I see. Well, then, I'm not going to stop sharing here because we need to go back. So now come the two little questions I told you about, right, about the more sensitive part of the interview, very quickly this part. So here we have, if you feel comfortable, if you don't want to, don't feel at ease, you can say, but these are some questions about your physical intimacy. So, the first one, have you had sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2: Oh my. There's no scale, right?

Speaker 1: No. I'm doing this off the scale.

Speaker 2: Okay. No.

Speaker 1: Okay. And how satisfied are you with your sex life, and why do you think that is?

Speaker 2: I would be satisfied, let me think here. Can I give a score for it even we don't have a scale here?

Speaker 1: Sure, go ahead. From 0 to 10. 1 to 10, better yet. 1 to 10.

Speaker 2: I would give it a 6, because I think we don't have a high frequency, but we have a lot of quality when we have our moments. And we're very relaxed about it because I think there are couples who are bothered, they worry about frequency. For [Partner] and me, that's not the most important thing. I think we could increase a little more, but that's because it ties in with other things, like not getting enough alone time together, even because of our child. That's why I give it a 6, but when we are together, the quality is very good.

Speaker 1: Going back to the scales, that was the main part I mentioned. Here we have this question. Can you still see it? How satisfied are you with this relationship? And I'd like you to indicate the phrase that best fits you.

Speaker 2: I understand. I think very satisfied, because completely satisfied is complicated,

Speaker 1: 100% satisfied is strong, it's very strong.

Speaker 2: So within your response of very satisfied, I'd like you to indicate within this other scale, being 0 not satisfied at all to 10 completely satisfied, which number would fit your very satisfied?

Speaker 1: 8.

Speaker 2: 8. And can you tell me why you'd say 8 in general?

Speaker 1: Because I think we need more quality moments together, we're lacking that. So we need more, and I'm not just talking about romantic moments, but doing activities together more frequently, like dancing classes, having hobbies together, because we've been living very separately lately in our routine. I think getting out of the routine and doing more things together.

Speaker 2: I understand. Well, I'll stop sharing here. Let me take a look. We're almost done with the interview. I had written down some words you mentioned that you considered important about respect, giving in to each other, showing importance in daily life, admiration, having those moments together daily, care, and I'd like to know if there's anything else to add, something I didn't ask or that you'd like to mention about these words I mentioned that are important to you?

Speaker 1: No, I think that's all.

Speaker 2: Okay. Alright.

Speaker 1: Well, [Name], I'd like to thank you for your participation, and I'd like to go back to the part I mentioned about the information moment. You had selected that. Oh no, you hadn't selected, but I can go over it again if you'd like. I can show it on the screen again, or if you'd like, I can just mention the two options. Those two options.

Speaker 2: I remember, you mentioned. Complete transcription then.

Speaker 1: Yes, complete transcription. Okay. So, now finishing the meeting, I'll send that document to your email, and you fill in what and sign it, okay? And send it back to me.

Speaker 2: Okay, I can send it. But I'll need to print it out to sign it and send it back?

Speaker 1: You mean save the document with your signature and all and send it back?

Speaker 2: Because to sign it, I'll need to print it, so I can do this, but right now I can't.

Speaker 1: If you want, you can sign digitally. Do you know how to do that? There are apps for that too. If you'd prefer, I can send you the name of an app that does that. You just literally take your phone and write your signature on the screen, it's much easier.

Speaker 2: I'd like that. I thought I'd have to print it.

Speaker 1: No, no. Digital signature is much easier.

Speaker 2: I know the one from the [app] does it. Would it be like that? What did you say? I

Speaker 1: didn't understand.

Speaker 2: The app. I think it charges for signing documents.

Speaker 1: I don't know if it lets you open it like that.

Speaker 2: I think I've never done it there, I don't remember.

Speaker 1: But there are many apps in the app store. I can send you some, there are several. But if the [app] works for you, great. And that's it.

Speaker 2: Okay then.

Speaker 1: Alright, [Name], thanks for agreeing to participate. I'll schedule another one with [Partner] later, he already replied to me, but he said his schedule is a bit busy. I'll schedule another one with him later.

Speaker 2: He's studying for the exam and the ideal would be after the exam. The spare time he has, he's using to study.

Speaker 1: Alright, no rush.

Speaker 2: Thanks.

Speaker 1: Thank you, [Name].

Speaker 2: Thanks. Bye.

Speaker 1: Bye.